UNIVERSITY OF SOUSSE
Faculty of Arts and Humanities of Sousse
Department of English

COURSE BOOKLET · STUDENT EDITION · SEMESTERS 1 AND 2

Academic Writing

Semester 1 · Writing Skills and Critical Reading
Semester 2 · Arguing about Literature

Third-Year Licence in English (L3) · Elective · TD · 28 hours per semester

Academic Year 2026–2027

Aligned with the official course description (Fiche descriptive d'un ECUE)

Student's name

Group

Tutor

Weekly lessons that follow the official programme · notes · workshop tasks · home assignments

BOOKLET

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EXAMPLE · How each weekly lesson is built

Every week follows the official programme: a **banner** with the lesson title and key sources, **Notes** (concepts, models, examples), **Practice** (workshop tasks done in class, with space for answers) and, where the programme requires a written product, a **Home assignment** that counts towards continuous assessment.

PART A

The Official Programme

Reproduced from the department's course description (Fiche descriptive d'un Élément Constitutif d'une Unité d'Enseignement). This booklet follows it week by week.

1. General information

Department	English — Licence: Anglais
Level of study	Third year (3ème année)
Teaching unit (module)	Elective
Course (matière)	Academic Writing
Type of teaching	TD
Semesters / hours	Semesters 1 and 2 · 28 hours per semester
Instructors named in the programme	Eya Sfar, Maram Ouertatani

2. General presentation

This two-semester course is designed to equip third-year students majoring in English with the advanced academic writing skills necessary for success in their disciplinary studies and beyond. This English for Specific Academic Purposes (ESAP) course focuses on developing students' abilities to engage critically with scholarly texts, formulate original arguments, and produce well-structured, research-based essays and papers. Through a combination of theoretical instruction, practical workshops, and peer review, students will learn to navigate the specific conventions and expectations of academic writing within their academic disciplines. The course emphasizes the development of critical thinking, research methodologies, and effective communication skills, preparing students for upper-level coursework, research projects, and potential graduate studies.

3. Prerequisites

Successful completion of second-year English courses.

4. Learning outcomes

By the end of the course students will be able to:

Domain	Students will be able to…
4.1 Cognitive skills	4.1.1 Analyze and synthesize complex academic texts related to literature, cultural studies, and linguistics. 4.1.2 Develop coherent arguments. 4.1.3 Apply critical thinking and analytical skills to evaluate scholarly sources and integrate them effectively into their writing. 4.1.4 Demonstrate a nuanced understanding of disciplinary-specific methodologies and theoretical frameworks. 4.1.5 Synthesize information from multiple sources to construct original academic arguments.
4.2 Interpersonal and emotional skills	4.2.1 Engage constructively in peer review and provide and receive constructive feedback. 4.2.2 Collaborate effectively in group projects and discussions. 4.2.3 Develop self-reflection and self-assessment skills to improve their writing process. 4.2.4 Manage time effectively and meet deadlines. 4.2.5 Display confidence in their ability to engage with scholarly material. 4.2.6 Develop resilience and persistence in the face of academic writing challenges.
4.3 Communication and technology	4.3.1 Produce clear, concise, and grammatically correct academic prose. 4.3.2 Employ appropriate academic vocabulary and terminology. 4.3.3 Structure and organize academic essays and research papers effectively. 4.3.4 Express ideas clearly and persuasively for academic audiences, both in written and oral formats. 4.3.5 Appropriately integrate citations and references using disciplinary citation styles (e.g., MLA, APA). 4.3.6 Use online academic databases and research tools effectively. 4.3.7 Use word processing software (e.g., Microsoft Word, Google Docs) to create and format academic documents.

Cognitive levels targeted (Bloom): Knowledge, Comprehension, Application, Analysis, Evaluation, Synthesis.

Outcome	Knowledge	Comprehension	Application	Analysis	Evaluation	Synthesis
4.1.1	✓	✓		✓		✓
4.1.2	✓		✓	✓	✓	✓
4.1.3			✓	✓	✓	✓
4.1.4				✓	✓	
4.1.5				✓		✓

5. Teaching and learning methods

- **Lectures and discussions:** to introduce key concepts, theories, and writing strategies.
- **Workshops:** focused on specific writing skills, such as thesis development, argumentation, and citation.
- **Peer review:** to provide students with constructive feedback and improve their writing through collaborative learning.
- **Analysis of model texts:** to examine exemplary academic writing from literature, cultural studies, and linguistics.
- **Research-based projects:** to apply writing skills to original research.
- **Use of online resources:** digital tools and databases to enhance research and writing skills.

6. Assessment

Type	Percentage
Home assignments, oral presentations	30 %
Devoir sur table (mid-term class test)	as set by the department
Examination	70 %
Total	**100 %**

- Feedback will be ongoing, and evaluation will emphasize both the process and the product of academic writing.
- Rubrics will assess clarity, structure, argumentation, use of sources, language accuracy, and adherence to disciplinary conventions.

7. Semester plans

Semester 1 — Writing skills and critical reading

Wk	Lesson	Content
1	General introduction	Objective of the course: writing and critical-thinking skills for future academic research · genres of academic writing (report, essay, thesis, article) and their differences (audience, purpose, style)
2	Writing an academic summary	Descriptive vs analytical summaries · balancing objective summary and the researcher's own interpretation (They say / I say)
3	Paraphrasing	Paraphrasing to summarize and avoid plagiarism · restructuring techniques that go beyond synonyms while preserving meaning
4	Reading critically	Text features (title, author, date, edition, abstract, contents, introduction, references, index) · assessing relevance and reliability · fact vs opinion; true vs false "facts"
5	Writing an annotated bibliography (1)	Citations and plagiarism · APA style (books, journal articles) · descriptive, summative, evaluative and reflective annotations
6	Writing an annotated bibliography (2)	Writing summative and evaluative annotations · writing an annotated bibliography
7	Synthesizing sources	Structure of a synthesis paper · building an argument · citing sources (APA) · first draft
8	Revision	Peer review and consultations on the synthesis draft · a checklist for revising
9	Expressing stance in a synthesis	Discourse markers of stance · stance in literature-review excerpts · final draft of the synthesis
10	Writing data commentaries	Sample data commentaries · structure · drafting a data commentary
11	Revision · Organization in data commentaries	Peer review of the draft · organizing data · linguistic features · final draft
12	Writing the abstract	Standard structure: background, aim and thesis, method, results · writing an abstract
13	Evaluation	Classroom mid-term test

Wk	Lesson	Content
14	Course wrap-up	Correction of the test and reflections on the course

Semester 2 — Arguing about literature

Wk	Lesson	Content
1	What is argument?	Understanding rhetoric · the elements of argument · a sample argument for analysis (The Bedford Handbook, pp. 141–198)
2	Writing effective arguments	Strategies for an effective style of argument · structure beyond the five-paragraph essay · analyzing a sample response
3	How to argue about literature	Two stories: Daniel Orozco, "Orientation"; Jamaica Kincaid, "Girl" · strategies for arguing about literature · a sample student argument
4	The reading process	Strategies for close reading · reading closely by annotating the two stories
5	Writing a comparative paper	Strategies for exploring and planning, applied to the two stories
6	Planning the comparative paper	Strategies for writing a comparative paper · strategies for composing · first draft
7	Revision · Quoting	Strategies for revising · a revision checklist · selecting and incorporating quotations (MLA) · final draft
8	Writing researched arguments	Analyzing a sample MLA paper · giving research direction · databases (JSTOR, MLA International Bibliography) · evaluating sources
9	Annotated bibliography in MLA format	Recording sources' key details · summarizing and paraphrasing
10	Planning the research paper	Reviewing scholarly debates · analyzing sample reviews from literary journals
11	Organizing the research paper	Structuring the research paper · building an argument · drafting
12	MLA style	Citing, incorporating and documenting sources · the list of works cited
13	Evaluation	Classroom mid-term test
14	Course wrap-up	Correction of the test and reflections on the course

8. References listed in the programme

Required textbooks

- Murray, N. (2012). *Writing essays in English language and linguistics: Principles, tips and strategies for undergraduates.* Cambridge University Press.
- Schilb, J., & Clifford, J. (2014). *Arguing about literature.* Bedford/St. Martin's.

Recommended reading

- Graff, G., & Birkenstein, C. (2021). *They say / I say: The moves that matter in academic writing* (5th ed.). W. W. Norton.
- Hyland, K. (2019). *Second language writing* (2nd ed.). Cambridge University Press.
- Flowerdew, J. (2015). *Academic discourse.* Routledge.
- Jago, C., Shea, R. H., Scanlon, L., & Aufses, R. D. (2011). *Literature and composition: Reading, writing, thinking.* Bedford/St. Martin's.
- Paltridge, B., & Starfield, S. (2016). *The handbook of academic writing.* Routledge.
- Starkey, D. (2024). *Academic writing now with readings: A brief guide for busy students.* Broadview Press.
- Spack, R. (2007). *Guidelines: A cross-cultural reading/writing text.* Cambridge University Press.
- Wright, L. (2024). *English grammar for literature students: How to analyse literary texts.* De Gruyter Mouton.

PART B

Working with this Booklet

How the official programme is turned into weekly lessons, products and assessment.

Two semesters, two projects

	Semester 1 · Writing skills and critical reading	Semester 2 · Arguing about literature
Main product	A **synthesis paper** (800–1,000 words) on a topic in literature, cultural studies or linguistics, built from an APA annotated bibliography	A **researched comparative argument** (1,500–2,000 words) on Orozco's "Orientation" and Kincaid's "Girl", in MLA style
Smaller products	Summaries · paraphrases · annotated bibliography · data commentary · abstract	Argument analysis · annotations · comparative paper · MLA annotated bibliography · research plan
Citation style	APA (7th edition)	MLA (9th edition)
Oral component	5-minute presentation of the synthesis argument (Week 9)	5-minute presentation of the research plan (Week 10)

Assessment at a glance

As the programme states: **30 %** home assignments and oral presentations, **70 %** final examination, plus a mid-term class test (devoir sur table) in Week 13 of each semester. Home assignments are marked in this booklet's blue **Home assignment** boxes and with the rubric in Appendix B.

Semester 1 home assignments	Due	Semester 2 home assignments	Due
HA1 · Analytical summary	Wk 3	HA1 · Argument analysis	Wk 2
HA2 · APA annotated bibliography (4 sources)	Wk 7	HA2 · Annotated reading of a story	Wk 5
HA3 · Synthesis paper, final draft + oral	Wk 9	HA3 · Comparative paper, final draft	Wk 8
HA4 · Data commentary, final draft	Wk 12	HA4 · MLA annotated bibliography + oral plan	Wk 10
HA5 · Abstract of the synthesis paper	Wk 13	HA5 · Researched argument, final draft	Wk 13

Key books behind this booklet

The notes draw on the core manuals of academic writing used in the previous edition, together with the two required textbooks of the programme. Full references are listed below in APA style, which you learn in Semester 1.

Book	Used mainly for
Graff & Birkenstein, *They Say / I Say*	Summary, quoting, responding, naysayers, "so what?", metacommentary
Swales & Feak, *Academic Writing for Graduate Students*	Genre, summaries, critiques, data commentary, abstracts, stance
Booth et al., *The Craft of Research*	Questions, sources and their reliability, the elements of argument
Williams & Bizup, *Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace*	Clarity, cohesion and concision during revision
Murray, *Writing Essays in English Language and Linguistics*	Critical reading, using sources, essay structure (programme textbook)
Schilb & Clifford, *Arguing about Literature*	Semester 2: rhetoric, literary issues, close reading, comparison, research (programme textbook)

Course bibliography (APA 7)

American Psychological Association. (2020). *Publication manual of the American Psychological Association* (7th ed.).

Booth, W. C., Colomb, G. G., Williams, J. M., Bizup, J., & FitzGerald, W. T. (2024). *The craft of research* (5th ed.). University of Chicago Press.

Graff, G., & Birkenstein, C. (2021). *"They say / I say": The moves that matter in academic writing* (5th ed.). W. W. Norton.

Hyland, K. (2005). Stance and engagement: A model of interaction in academic discourse. *Discourse Studies, 7*(2), 173–192.

McCarthy, M., & O'Dell, F. (2016). *Academic vocabulary in use* (2nd ed.). Cambridge University Press.

Modern Language Association of America. (2021). *MLA handbook* (9th ed.).

Morley, J. (n.d.). *Academic phrasebank.* University of Manchester. https://www.phrasebank.manchester.ac.uk/

Murray, N. (2012). *Writing essays in English language and linguistics: Principles, tips and strategies for undergraduates.* Cambridge University Press.

Pinker, S. (2014). *The sense of style: The thinking person's guide to writing in the 21st century.* Viking.

Schilb, J., & Clifford, J. (2014). *Arguing about literature: A guide and reader.* Bedford/St. Martin's.

Swales, J. M., & Feak, C. B. (2012). *Academic writing for graduate students: Essential tasks and skills* (3rd ed.). University of Michigan Press.

Williams, J. M., & Bizup, J. (2015). *Style: The basics of clarity and grace* (5th ed.). Pearson.

PART C

Semester 1 · Writing Skills and Critical Reading

Twelve weekly lessons, a mid-term test and a wrap-up session, as set out in the official programme.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 1

General Introduction: Genres of Academic Writing

Why academic writing is research and critical thinking in written form; how the main genres differ in audience, purpose and style.

Key sources: Swales & Feak, Unit 1; Graff & Birkenstein, Introduction; Murray, Ch. 1

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

1.1 What this course is for

Academic writing is how researchers think in public. Graff and Birkenstein describe it as joining a **conversation**: you listen to what others have said (*they say*) and then add your own contribution (*I say*). Each skill in Semester 1 — summarising, paraphrasing, reading critically, citing, synthesising, commenting on data, abstracting — is one move in that conversation, and each prepares you for the research paper, the mémoire and graduate study.

1.2 Six considerations for every text

Swales and Feak ask writers to plan every text around six considerations: **audience, purpose, organisation, style, flow and presentation**. Genres are the conventional answers a discipline has found to these questions.

1.3 The main genres compared

Genre	Audience	Purpose	Typical structure	Style
Essay	Tutor; informed reader	Argue a position on a question	Introduction with thesis · body paragraphs · conclusion	Argumentative; first person often acceptable in the humanities
Report	Decision-makers; colleagues	Inform about findings or a situation; recommend	Headed sections: summary, introduction, method, findings, recommendations	Concise, impersonal, visual (tables, lists)
Research article	Specialists in the field	Present new knowledge to peers	Abstract · introduction · (method) · analysis/results · discussion · references	Dense, cited, cautious (hedged)
Thesis / mémoire	Examiners; the discipline	Show mastery and an original contribution	Chapters: introduction, literature review, method, analysis, conclusion	Extended, systematic, fully referenced

KEY IDEA · Register

Academic register is not "big words": it is **precision, economy and appropriate distance**. Prefer *investigate* to *look into*, *considerable* to *a lot of*, *do not* to *don't*, and support every general claim ("It is widely accepted that…") with a source.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 1.1 Name the genre ⏱ 10 min

Read each extract (constructed for practice). Identify the genre, the likely reader and the purpose.

EXAMPLE · Extracts

A. "This study examines code-switching in 24 recorded EFL lessons at two Tunisian universities. Results indicate that…"

B. "Following the survey, we recommend that the library extend its opening hours during examination periods."

C. "In this essay I argue that Eliot's Tiresias is less a prophet than a witness, and that this distinction…"

D. "Chapter 2 reviews the literature on narrative voice before Chapter 3 sets out the corpus and method."

Extract	Genre	Reader	Purpose
A			

Extract	Genre	Reader	Purpose
B			
C			
D			

Task 1.2 Raise the register ⏱ 10 min

Rewrite each sentence in academic English without changing the meaning.

1. Lots of people think that social media is killing reading.
2. The author looks into a bunch of old novels and finds out some weird stuff.
3. It's obvious that the poem is about death.

Task 1.3 Diagnostic paragraph ⏱ 15 min

On a separate sheet, write one paragraph (about 120 words): *Which kind of academic text do you find most difficult to write, and why?* Keep it in your portfolio; you will revisit it in Week 14.

FURTHER READING

- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 1, "An Approach to Academic Writing".
- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Introduction, "Entering the Conversation".
- Murray (2012), chapter on the nature of academic essays.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 2

Writing an Academic Summary

Descriptive versus analytical summaries; balancing a faithful account of a source with your own interpretation (They say / I say).

Key sources: Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 2; Swales & Feak, Unit 5; Murray

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

2.1 Descriptive and analytical summaries

	Descriptive summary	Analytical summary
Question it answers	What does the text say?	What does the text do, how, and how well?
Content	Main claim and key points, in order	Main claim, method, assumptions, significance
Writer's voice	Neutral, absent	Present but clearly separated from the author's
Typical verbs	states, describes, explains, outlines	argues, assumes, overlooks, demonstrates, challenges
Used in	Notes, abstracts, descriptive annotations	Essays, literature reviews, evaluative annotations

2.2 How to write a summary

1. Read the whole text; identify the **question** it answers and its **main claim**.
2. Mark the key supporting points — not every example or statistic.
3. Close the source and write from your notes, in your own words and structure.
4. Check against the original for accuracy and distortion.
5. Name the author early, and remind the reader whose ideas these are ("Hassan further argues…").

KEY IDEA · They say / I say

Graff and Birkenstein warn against two failures: the **list summary** (one point after another, with no focus) and the **closest-cousin summary** (the writer's own views slip in). A good summary is faithful to the author *and* selected for the point you will make next. Mark the shift clearly: "X argues that… **I agree / I would add / I question** that…"

Function	Reporting verbs (present tense for ideas)
Neutral	states, notes, describes, reports, observes
Strong	argues, insists, maintains, demonstrates, contends
Tentative	suggests, implies, proposes, speculates
Critical distance	claims, alleges, assumes, purports

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

EXAMPLE · Source passage (constructed for practice)

Many teachers fear that screen reading has made students incapable of sustained attention to literature. Yet the evidence is mixed. Students who read novels on phones report reading more often, in short bursts, and many say they re-read passages they would have skipped in print. What seems to suffer is not attention as such but **slow, connected reading** — the ability to hold a whole chapter in mind and relate its parts. Rather than banning devices, teachers might design tasks that reward connection: tracking an image across a novel, or comparing an opening with an ending. The problem, in other words, is pedagogical before it is technological. — *Ben Salah, R. (2024). Reading in fragments. Journal of Literary Pedagogy, 9(1), 22–35.*

Task 2.1 Descriptive summary ⏱ 10 min

Summarise the passage in 40–50 words. Start with a reporting verb ("Ben Salah (2024) argues that…").

Task 2.2 From descriptive to analytical ⏱ 15 min

Rewrite your summary as an analytical summary (60–80 words): say what kind of argument the author makes, what it assumes, and add one clearly marked sentence of your own response.

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA1 · Analytical summary · due Week 3

Choose one scholarly article (8–20 pages) on a topic in literature, cultural studies or linguistics. Write an analytical summary of **180–220 words** and attach the first page of the article. This article can become the first source of your synthesis paper.

FURTHER READING

- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 2, "Her Point Is: The Art of Summarizing".
- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 5, "Writing Summaries".

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 3

Paraphrasing

Paraphrase as a tool to condense, integrate and avoid plagiarism; techniques that restructure a text instead of swapping synonyms.

Key sources: Swales & Feak, Unit 5; Murray; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 2

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

3.1 What a paraphrase is

A paraphrase restates a **specific passage** in your own words and structure, at roughly the same length, keeping the original meaning. A summary condenses a whole text; a paraphrase rewrites part of one. Both must be cited. Changing a few words while keeping the author's sentence pattern is **patchwriting**, which counts as plagiarism.

3.2 Techniques: restructure first, then replace

Technique	Original	Paraphrase
Change sentence structure	Rapid urbanisation has transformed the city's social fabric.	Social life in the city has changed because the city grew so quickly.
Change word class	Writers respond to criticism.	Criticism prompts a response from writers.
Change voice	Critics have largely ignored her later poems.	Her later poems have received little critical attention.
Split or combine	A long sentence with three clauses	Two shorter sentences, re-ordered by importance
Careful synonyms	increase significantly	rise considerably (not "grow heavily")
Keep technical terms	free indirect discourse	free indirect discourse (no synonym exists)

WRITER'S TIP · A five-step routine

Read until you understand → **cover** the source → **write** from memory → **compare** for meaning and wording → **cite** (author, year, page).

WATCH OUT · Forms of plagiarism

- Copying without quotation marks and citation.
- Patchwriting: original structure with a few words changed.
- Uncited paraphrase or idea: your words, someone else's thought.
- Submitting text produced by a generative-AI tool or another person as your own, contrary to the department's rules.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 3.1 Acceptable or plagiarised? 10 min

Original: "What seems to suffer is not attention as such but slow, connected reading." (Ben Salah, 2024, p. 23). Judge each version and explain.

Version	Verdict and reason
a) What seems to be damaged is not attention in itself but slow, linked reading (Ben Salah, 2024).	
b) According to Ben Salah (2024), screens weaken our capacity to relate parts of a long text rather than our attention span in general.	
c) Screen reading does not harm attention; it harms the ability to read slowly and connect ideas.	

Task 3.2 Paraphrase with two techniques 20 min

Paraphrase the two sentences below. Name the techniques you used and add an APA in-text citation.

1. "Rather than banning devices, teachers might design tasks that reward connection." (Ben Salah, 2024, p. 24)
2. "The problem, in other words, is pedagogical before it is technological." (Ben Salah, 2024, p. 24)

FURTHER READING

- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 5, sections on paraphrasing and plagiarism.
- Murray (2012), chapter on using sources and avoiding plagiarism.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 4

Reading Critically

Using text features to read efficiently; judging relevance and reliability; telling fact from opinion and true facts from false "facts".

Key sources: Booth et al., Ch. 5–6; Murray; Swales & Feak, Unit 6

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

4.1 Text features: read the outside before the inside

Feature	What it tells you
Title and subtitle	Topic, angle, often the argument (the subtitle is usually more specific)
Author	Expertise and affiliation — check a university page or previous publications
Publication date and edition	Currency; later editions may revise arguments and data
Publisher / journal	Peer review and reputation (university press, refereed journal, website)
Abstract, contents, introduction	Research question, scope, structure — decide here whether to read on
References / bibliography	Whether the claims are supported, and leads to further sources
Index	Fast access to the exact pages on your topic

4.2 Relevance and reliability

Booth et al. advise beginning with sources that are **reliable by default** — books from reputable presses, peer-reviewed journals, authors who are recognised scholars — and then asking of every source: Is it **recent** enough? Is it **relevant** to my question? Does it **cite** its evidence? Is its **style** formal and its purpose to inform rather than to sell or persuade?

Source type	Examples	Use in academic work
Scholarly	Refereed journal articles, academic monographs	Main evidence and positions to discuss
Reference	Encyclopedias, handbooks, dictionaries	Orientation; rarely cited as authority
Popular	Newspapers, magazines, blogs	Context or examples, used with care
Unreliable	Anonymous pages, uncited claims, AI-generated text	Not as evidence; verify elsewhere

4.3 Fact, opinion — and false "facts"

- A **fact** can be checked ("*The Waste Land* was first published in 1922").
- An **opinion** expresses a preference ("It is the most beautiful poem of the century").
- A **claim** is an arguable position supported by reasons and evidence — the heart of academic writing.
- A **false "fact"** looks checkable but is wrong or unsupported: numbers with no source, misattributed quotations, outdated data. Check it **laterally**: open other trusted sources to see what they say about the claim and its origin.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 4.1 Fact, opinion, claim or false "fact"? 10 min

Label each statement F, O, C or FF and justify one choice in writing.

1. Shakespeare wrote 37 novels.
2. Kincaid's "Girl" was first published in *The New Yorker* in 1978.
3. Postcolonial readings are boring.
4. Code-switching in class can support comprehension for beginning learners.
5. Eighty per cent of students never read the assigned books (a viral post).
6. Hemingway's short sentences mask, rather than reduce, emotional intensity.

Task 4.2 Evaluate a source 15 min

In pairs, examine the book or article your tutor gives you. Fill in the grid.

Criterion	Evidence from the text features	Score 1–3
Author and expertise		
Date / edition		
Publisher / peer review		
Citations and references		
Relevance to my topic		

FURTHER READING

- Booth et al. (2024), chapters on finding and engaging sources.
- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 6, "Writing Critiques".

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 5

Writing an Annotated Bibliography (1): Citing in APA

Why we cite; APA 7 for books and journal articles; the four types of annotation.

Key sources: APA Publication Manual (7th ed.); Murray; Swales & Feak

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

5.1 Why cite?

Citation lets readers **find** your sources, **credits** other scholars, shows which ideas are **yours**, and protects you from plagiarism. APA uses an **author–date** system: a short citation in the text points to a full entry in the reference list.

5.2 APA in-text citations

Situation	Narrative citation	Parenthetical citation
One author	Murray (2012) argues…	(Murray, 2012)
Two authors	Graff and Birkenstein (2021)	(Graff & Birkenstein, 2021)
Three or more	Booth et al. (2024)	(Booth et al., 2024)
Direct quotation	Swales and Feak (2012) note that "…" (p. 45).	(Swales & Feak, 2012, p. 45)

5.3 APA reference list entries

Type	Pattern and example
Book	Author, A. A. (Year). *Title of the book in sentence case* (ed.). Publisher. Murray, N. (2012). *Writing essays in English language and linguistics.* Cambridge University Press.
Journal article	Author, A. A., & Author, B. B. (Year). Title of article. *Journal Name, volume*(issue), pages. https://doi.org/… Hyland, K. (2005). Stance and engagement: A model of interaction in academic discourse. *Discourse Studies, 7*(2), 173–192.
Chapter in an edited book	Author, A. A. (Year). Title of chapter. In E. E. Editor (Ed.), *Title of book* (pp. x–y). Publisher.

WRITER'S TIP · Formatting the list

Alphabetical by first author's surname · hanging indent · double-spaced · sentence case for article and book titles · title case and italics for journal names · italicise the volume number, not the issue.

5.4 Four types of annotation

Type	What it does	Example sentence
Descriptive	Describes scope and content without judging	"The book surveys essay conventions in linguistics…"
Summative	Summarises the main argument and evidence	"Murray argues that successful essays answer the question asked…"
Evaluative	Summarises, then assesses strengths and limits	"Its examples are clear, but it rarely addresses literary essays."
Reflective	Explains how the source serves your project	"This framework will structure my second section."

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 5.1 Correct the references ⏱ 15 min

Each APA entry contains two or more errors. Rewrite it correctly.

1. Graff, Gerald and Cathy Birkenstein. They Say I Say. 2021. Norton.
2. Hyland, K. Stance And Engagement. Discourse Studies, 2005, 7, 2, p. 173-192.
3. Swales J. & Feak C. (2012) *Academic Writing For Graduate Students*, University of Michigan Press, 3rd edition.

Task 5.2 Identify the type ⏱ 5 min

Return to the example sentences in 5.4. Write one more sentence of each type about a source you are reading for HA1.

FURTHER READING

- American Psychological Association (2020), Ch. 8–10 (citations and references).
- APA Style website: sample reference list and annotated bibliography pages.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 6

Writing an Annotated Bibliography (2)

Writing summative and evaluative annotations; assembling a complete annotated bibliography.

Key sources: Swales & Feak, Units 5–6; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 2; Booth et al.

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

6.1 The moves of a good annotation

Move	Content	Useful language
1 Reference	Full APA entry with hanging indent	—
2 Main claim	The source's central argument or purpose	X argues / sets out to show that…
3 Method and scope	How the claim is supported; corpus, period, approach	Drawing on…, the author analyses…
4 Evaluation	Strengths, limits, bias, currency	persuasively / convincingly; however, it overlooks…
5 Relevance	How the source serves your topic	This study is useful for…, although…

EXAMPLE · Model evaluative annotation (about 130 words)

Graff, G., & Birkenstein, C. (2021). *"They say / I say": The moves that matter in academic writing* (5th ed.). W. W. Norton.

Graff and Birkenstein argue that academic writing is a conversation in which writers must represent others' views ("they say") before advancing their own ("I say"). Their method is practical: each chapter isolates a rhetorical move — summarising, quoting, agreeing with a difference, anticipating objections — and supplies templates students can adapt. The book's strength lies in making implicit conventions explicit; its templates are especially helpful for second-language writers. However, critics might object that templates risk formulaic prose, and the examples come mostly from American public debate rather than from literary or linguistic research. For my project on code-switching, the chapters on summarising and on responding to sources will guide the structure of my synthesis paragraphs.

6.2 Assembling the bibliography

- A title ("Annotated Bibliography: Code-Switching in the EFL Classroom") and a 2–3 sentence statement of scope.
- Entries in alphabetical order, each followed by its annotation (100–150 words) in a separate indented paragraph.
- A consistent annotation type, as required by the assignment.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 6.1 Label the moves ⏱ 10 min

In the model annotation, mark moves 2–5 in the margin. Underline the language of evaluation.

Task 6.2 Write a summative annotation ⏱ 20 min

Write a summative annotation (80–100 words) of the Ben Salah (2024) passage from Week 2, with its APA reference first.

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA2 · APA annotated bibliography · due Week 7

Choose the topic of your synthesis paper. Compile an annotated bibliography of **four scholarly sources** (at least two journal articles), with **two summative and two evaluative** annotations of 100–150 words each, plus a short scope statement. Format in APA 7 with a word processor (hanging indents, alphabetical order).

FURTHER READING

- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 6 (evaluative language for critiques).
- Booth et al. (2024), chapter on engaging sources and recording bibliographic data.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 7

Synthesizing Sources

The structure of a synthesis paper; building an argument across sources; citing several sources in APA; the first draft.

Key sources: Booth et al., Ch. 7–8; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 4; Murray; Swales & Feak

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

7.1 Summary versus synthesis

A series of summaries discusses **one source per paragraph**. A synthesis discusses **one idea per paragraph** and shows how several sources agree, extend, qualify or contradict one another — and what follows from that. The synthesis paper therefore needs its own claim, not just the sum of other people's.

Source-by-source (avoid)	Theme-by-theme (aim for)
¶1 Source A says… ¶2 Source B says… ¶3 Source C says…	¶1 Theme 1: A and C agree that…; B qualifies this… ¶2 Theme 2: B and C disagree about… ¶3 Gap: none of them examines…

7.2 Structure of a synthesis paper

Part	Content
Introduction	Topic and why it matters · the conversation in brief · your synthesis claim (thesis)
Body paragraphs	Topic sentence stating a theme → sources compared (agree / differ / extend) → your comment on the significance
Conclusion	What the sources together show · the gap or open question · implications for further research
References	APA list of every source cited

7.3 Building the argument

Booth et al. describe an argument as a **claim** supported by **reasons**, which rest on **evidence**, with an **acknowledgment and response** to other views. In a synthesis, the evidence is the pattern you find across sources. Graff and Birkenstein's three moves help you position yourself: **agree** (with a difference), **disagree** (with reasons), or **agree and disagree simultaneously**.

WRITER'S TIP · Language of synthesis

- Both X (2019) and Y (2021) emphasise…, whereas Z (2023) argues…
- Building on X's findings, Y shows that…
- These studies converge on… but differ on…
- Several researchers (Ayari, 2020; Brown & Lee, 2018; Chen, 2022) report… — list sources alphabetically, separated by semicolons.

EXAMPLE · Model synthesis paragraph (different topic; sources constructed)

[**Topic sentence / claim**] Research on translating humour agrees that jokes rarely survive literal translation, but it disagrees about what translators should sacrifice. [**Sources in dialogue**] Haddad (2019) and Martin (2021) both show that wordplay is the first casualty, yet they draw opposite conclusions: Haddad recommends replacing a pun with a local equivalent, whereas Martin argues that such substitution erases the cultural specificity readers seek in translated fiction. Okafor (2023) partly reconciles these positions by distinguishing comic dialogue, where the effect matters most, from narration, where the original reference can be footnoted. [**Writer's comment**] What none of these studies examines, however, is how readers themselves respond — a gap that makes their recommendations difficult to test.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 7.1 Build a synthesis matrix ⏱ 15 min

Three sources (constructed) on code-switching in EFL classes: **Ayari (2020)** — teachers' switches to Arabic aid comprehension of grammar; **Brown & Lee (2018)** — frequent switching reduces learners' exposure to English; **Chen (2022)** — switching helps when planned for specific functions (e.g., instructions), harms when habitual. Complete the matrix.

Theme	Ayari (2020)	Brown & Lee (2018)	Chen (2022)	My comment
Effect on comprehension				
Effect on exposure				
Conditions for use				

Task 7.2 Write a synthesis paragraph ⏱ 20 min

Using the matrix, write one theme-based paragraph (120–150 words) with a topic sentence, at least two sources in dialogue, APA citations and a sentence of your own comment. Then draft your own synthesis paper at home (600–800 words) for peer review in Week 8.

FURTHER READING

- Booth et al. (2024), chapters on making claims, assembling reasons and evidence.
- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 4, "Yes / No / Okay, But".

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 8

Revision: Peer Review of the Synthesis Draft

Revising from global to local; giving and using peer feedback; a revision checklist.

Key sources: Booth et al., Ch. 12; Williams & Bizup, Lessons 3–5; Graff & Birkenstein

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

8.1 Revision is re-seeing

Revising changes the argument and organisation; **editing** improves sentences; **proofreading** corrects surface errors. Booth et al. recommend revising from the outside in: first the claim and the structure, then paragraphs, then sentences and words. Williams and Bizup add two sentence-level tests: make **characters the subjects** and **actions the verbs**, and begin sentences with **old information** before introducing new.

Level	Revision checklist for the synthesis paper
Argument	☐ Is there a synthesis claim in the introduction? ☐ Does each paragraph serve it?
Organisation	☐ Are paragraphs organised by theme, not by source? ☐ Is each topic sentence a claim?
Use of sources	☐ Are sources compared (agree / differ / extend)? ☐ Is my voice distinguishable from theirs?
Citation	☐ Every borrowed idea cited? ☐ APA in-text and reference list consistent?

Level	Revision checklist for the synthesis paper
Sentences	☐ Characters as subjects, actions as verbs? ☐ Old → new information? ☐ No needless words?
Surface	☐ Grammar, spelling, punctuation, formatting checked by reading aloud?

KEY IDEA · Useful peer feedback

Feedback is useful when it is **specific, text-based and actionable**. Use the pattern **Describe → Evaluate → Suggest**: "Your second paragraph discusses only Brown & Lee (describe); the theme of exposure disappears (evaluate); could you bring Chen in to qualify their view? (suggest)."

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 8.1 Peer review 30 min

Exchange drafts. Answer in full sentences on your partner's draft or here.

Question	Comment
What is the writer's synthesis claim? Copy it or say it is missing.	
Which paragraph synthesises best, and why?	
Where does the paper become a list of summaries?	
Two specific suggestions for revision	

Task 8.2 Revise for clarity 10 min

Revise using characters as subjects and actions as verbs: "The examination of the use of code-switching by teachers was carried out by Chen, with a demonstration of its usefulness in the case of the provision of instructions."

FURTHER READING

- Booth et al. (2024), chapter on revising your organisation and argument.
- Williams & Bizup (2015), lessons on actions, characters and cohesion.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 9

Expressing Stance in a Synthesis

Discourse markers of stance; analysing literature-review excerpts; the final draft of the synthesis paper.

Key sources: Hyland (2005); Swales & Feak; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 5

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

9.1 What is stance?

Stance is the way writers show **how certain they are** and **what they think** of the ideas they present. Hyland identifies four main stance resources in academic writing. Using them well lets you sound confident where the evidence is strong and cautious where it is not.

Marker	Function	Examples
Hedges	Withhold full commitment; signal caution	may, might, suggest, appear, possibly, to some extent, tend to
Boosters	Express certainty; close down alternatives	clearly, demonstrate, in fact, undoubtedly, show
Attitude markers	Express evaluation or affect	importantly, surprisingly, unfortunately, crucial, convincing
Self-mention	Present the writer's own voice	I argue, my analysis, this paper contends

9.2 Stance in literature reviews

- **Reporting verbs** carry stance: *Brown and Lee show* (writer accepts) vs *Brown and Lee claim* (writer distances).
- **Integral** citations put the author in the sentence (Chen (2022) argues…); **non-integral** citations foreground the idea (… (Chen, 2022)). Swales and Feak note that the choice shifts attention between researcher and finding.
- Graff and Birkenstein call for **voice markers** so readers always know who is speaking: *Although Ayari suggests…, I contend that…*

WRITER'S TIP · Stance templates

- **Cautious:** The evidence suggests that… · It seems likely that… · This may partly explain…
- **Confident:** The data clearly show… · It is evident that… · X convincingly demonstrates…
- **Evaluative:** A particularly valuable contribution is… · A notable limitation of X's study is…
- **Positioning:** Although X maintains…, I contend that… · While I agree with X that…, I would add…

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 9.1 Analyse a literature-review excerpt ⏱ 15 min

Underline every stance marker and classify it in the table.

EXAMPLE · Excerpt (constructed)

Early studies **clearly** viewed code-switching as a sign of deficient proficiency (Brown & Lee, 2018). More recent research, however, **suggests** that switching **may** serve specific pedagogical functions (Ayari, 2020; Chen, 2022). **Surprisingly**, few studies have examined learners' own perceptions. In this paper **I argue** that such perceptions are **crucial** to any policy on classroom language.

Hedges	Boosters	Attitude markers	Self-mention

Task 9.2 Adjust the strength ⏱ 10 min

Hedge the over-claims and strengthen the under-claims.

1. Code-switching always destroys learners' fluency.
2. It is perhaps possible that some teachers might switch for instructions.
3. All the studies prove that planned switching works.

HOME ASSIGNMENT · **HA3 · Synthesis paper, final draft + oral presentation · due Week 9**

Submit the revised synthesis paper (**800–1,000 words**, APA 7, typed, 1.5 spacing, page numbers) with the peer-review sheet and a five-line revision note. Present your synthesis claim and its main themes in a **5-minute oral presentation** with one slide or handout.

FURTHER READING

- Hyland, K. (2005). Stance and engagement. *Discourse Studies, 7*(2), 173–192.
- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 5, "And Yet: Distinguishing What You Say from What They Say".

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 10

Writing Data Commentaries

What a data commentary does; its typical structure; analysing a model and drafting your own.

Key sources: Swales & Feak, Unit 4; APA Manual, Ch. 7 (tables and figures)

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

10.1 Purpose

A data commentary is a short text that **interprets** a table, chart or graph. Swales and Feak stress that it should not repeat every figure: it **highlights** what is significant, **explains** it and **qualifies** the explanation. In the humanities you meet data in survey-based linguistics, corpus studies, reading research and cultural statistics.

10.2 Typical structure

Element	Function	Language
Location + summary	Point to the data and state its overall message	Table 1 shows / As can be seen in Figure 2,…
Highlighting statements	Select the most important results and comparisons	The most striking feature is… · X is almost twice as high as Y.
Discussion	Explain, compare with previous research, note exceptions or problems	This may reflect… · One possible explanation is… · An exception is…
Implication / recommendation	Say what the data mean for the field or for practice	These results suggest that… · Further research should…

EXAMPLE · **Model data commentary (data constructed for practice)**

Table 1. Weekly reading by 120 L3 English students (hours, mean)	Print	Screen
Assigned literary texts	2.1	1.4
Literary criticism	0.6	1.1
Leisure reading	1.2	4.8

[**Location + summary**] Table 1 shows that L3 students read considerably more on screens than in print, but that the pattern depends on the type of text. [**Highlight**] Leisure reading is four times higher on screens (4.8 vs 1.2 hours), whereas assigned literary texts are still read mainly in print. [**Discussion**] This difference may reflect the availability of course texts as photocopies rather than e-books. Criticism, by contrast, is read largely online, probably through open-access databases. [**Implication**] These results suggest that screen reading need not be resisted but guided, particularly for critical sources.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 10.1 Analyse the model ⏱ 10 min

Which figures does the writer leave out, and why? Find two hedges and one comparison structure.

Task 10.2 Draft a data commentary ⏱ 25 min

Write a first draft (120–150 words) on the table below, following the four elements.

Table 2. Sources cited in 200 L3 essays (%)	2024–25	2025–26
Books	46	38
Journal articles	18	27
Websites	30	22
Unacknowledged AI tools (detected)	6	13

FURTHER READING

- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 4, “Data Commentary”.
- APA (2020), Ch. 7, on presenting tables and figures.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 11

Revision · Organization and Language of Data Commentaries

Peer review of the data-commentary draft; organising data; linguistic features; the final draft.

Key sources: Swales & Feak, Unit 4; Williams & Bizup; Hyland

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

11.1 Organising the data

- **General → specific**: begin with the overall pattern, then the details that support or complicate it.
- **By importance**: the most striking result first, not the first row of the table.
- **By comparison**: group items that contrast (print vs screen; 2024–25 vs 2025–26).
- **Exceptions last**: deal with surprising cases after the main trend, and try to explain them.

11.2 Linguistic features

Feature	Guidance and examples
Tense	Present for what the table shows (*Table 2 shows*); past for what was done (*the essays were collected in 2025*).
Trends	rose sharply / increased slightly / fell from 30% to 22% / remained stable / peaked at
Comparison	twice as many as · considerably higher than · by contrast · whereas · compared with

Feature	Guidance and examples
Approximation	approximately, nearly, just over a quarter, the majority of, roughly one in eight
Qualification	may indicate · appears to · it is possible that — avoid *prove* for interpretations
Numbers	APA: words for one to nine, figures for 10 and above; figures for percentages (13%)

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 11.1 Correct the commentary ⏱ 10 min

Identify and correct six weaknesses (organisation, tense, over-claiming, repetition of figures).

EXAMPLE · Weak draft

In the table we saw that books was 46 and then 38, journal articles was 18 and then 27, websites was 30 and 22 and AI was 6 and 13. This proves that students are cheating more. Journal articles went up.

Task 11.2 Peer review the data commentary ⏱ 15 min

Exchange your Week 10 drafts and check: ☐ location + summary ☐ selection of key figures ☐ explanations hedged ☐ trend and comparison language accurate ☐ implication stated. Write two suggestions for your partner.

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA4 · Data commentary, final draft · due Week 12

Revise your commentary on Table 2 (**150–200 words**) using your peer's feedback. Insert the table into a word-processed document with an APA-style number and title, and submit both drafts.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 12

Writing the Abstract

The standard abstract structure — background, aim and thesis, method, results — and writing an abstract of your own paper.

Key sources: Swales & Feak; Booth et al.; APA Manual, Ch. 2

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

12.1 What an abstract is for

An abstract is a **stand-alone summary** of a paper that helps readers decide whether to read it and helps databases index it. APA limits abstracts to **250 words**; most journals in literature and linguistics ask for 150–250 words followed by 3–5 **keywords**. It contains no citations and no information absent from the paper.

Move	Question it answers	Typical tense and language
1 Background	What is the context or problem?	Present: *Code-switching is common in…, yet…*
2 Aim and thesis	What does the paper do and argue?	Present: *This paper examines… It argues that…*
3 Method	How was it done? Which corpus or texts?	Past or present: *Drawing on 24 lessons, the study analysed…*

Move	Question it answers	Typical tense and language
4 Results	What was found?	Past/present: *The analysis shows that…*
5 Conclusion (optional)	Why does it matter?	Present + hedge: *These findings suggest…*

WRITER'S TIP · Informative or indicative?

An **informative** abstract reports the actual findings ("the analysis shows that…"). An **indicative** abstract only describes what the paper covers ("the paper discusses…"). Prefer informative abstracts: they tell the reader what you found.

EXAMPLE · Model informative abstract (literature; about 120 words)

[**Background**] Kate Chopin's "The Story of an Hour" (1894) is usually read as a story of liberation cut short. [**Aim and thesis**] This paper argues that the story's ending does not cancel Louise Mallard's freedom but exposes the social narrative that can only explain a woman's death as heart failure caused by joy. [**Method**] Drawing on a close reading of the story's final sentence and on feminist criticism of Chopin's short fiction, the analysis traces the gap between Louise's inner speech and the doctors' diagnosis. [**Results**] It shows that the narrator's irony aligns the reader with Louise rather than with the onlookers. [**Conclusion**] The story thus stages the misreading of women's desire as a medical fact. **Keywords:** Chopin, irony, short story, feminist criticism

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 12.1 Reorder the abstract 10 min

Put the sentences in order (1–5) and label each move.

Sentence	Order	Move
a) The analysis shows that planned switches clarified instructions, whereas habitual switches reduced English input.		
b) These findings suggest that teacher training should address the functions of switching rather than ban it.		
c) Code-switching is widespread in Tunisian EFL classrooms, yet its effects remain disputed.		
d) Twenty-four recorded lessons were transcribed and each switch was coded for function.		
e) This paper investigates which functions of teacher code-switching support learning.		

Task 12.2 Abstract your synthesis paper 20 min

Write a 120–150-word informative abstract of your synthesis paper with three keywords. (For a synthesis, "method" means the sources and how you compared them.)

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA5 · Abstract · due Week 13

Submit the final abstract of your synthesis paper (max. 150 words + keywords), word-processed, as the first page of your Semester 1 portfolio.

SEMESTER 1 · WEEK 13–14

Mid-Term Test and Course Wrap-Up

Week 13: classroom mid-term test. Week 14: correction of the test and reflection on the semester.

Key sources: All Semester 1 lessons

Preparing for the test

Skill (week)	I can…	✓
Genres (1)	identify the audience, purpose and style of an academic genre	
Summary (2)	write a descriptive and an analytical summary with reporting verbs	
Paraphrase (3)	paraphrase by restructuring, and recognise patchwriting	
Critical reading (4)	evaluate a source and distinguish fact, opinion, claim and false “fact”	
APA & annotation (5–6)	write correct APA references and summative/evaluative annotations	
Synthesis (7–9)	write a theme-based paragraph that relates sources and expresses stance	
Data commentary (10–11)	interpret a table with highlighting, discussion and hedged implications	
Abstract (12)	write an abstract with background, aim, method and results	

Week 14 · Reflection

Re-read your Week 1 diagnostic paragraph and your corrected test. Write 80–100 words: *What has changed in the way I read and write academic texts, and what is my main goal for Semester 2?*

PART D

Semester 2 · Arguing about Literature

From the elements of argument to a researched literary argument in MLA style, following the official programme.

WATCH OUT · Texts you need

Bring your own copy of Daniel Orozco, "Orientation", and Jamaica Kincaid, "Girl", both reprinted in Schilb and Clifford, *Arguing about Literature*. The stories are not reproduced in this booklet for copyright reasons; your tutor will tell you where to find them.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 1

What Is Argument?

Understanding rhetoric; the elements of argument; analysing a sample argument.

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford, Part One; The Bedford Handbook, pp. 141–198; Booth et al.

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

1.1 Rhetoric: the art of persuading an audience

An argument is not a quarrel. In academic writing it is a reasoned attempt to persuade a specific **audience** to accept a **claim** about an **issue** on which reasonable people can disagree. Every argument takes place in a **rhetorical situation**: a writer, an audience, a purpose and a context.

Appeal	Persuades through…	In literary argument
Logos	reasoning and evidence	textual details, patterns, logical links between them
Ethos	the writer's credibility	accuracy, fairness to other readings, careful citation
Pathos	the audience's values and emotions	showing why the reading matters to readers today

1.2 The elements of argument

Element	Definition	Question to ask
Issue	A question that is open to debate	What exactly is in dispute?
Claim	The writer's answer to the issue — the thesis	Is it arguable, specific and significant?
Reasons and evidence	Why the claim holds; the facts, details or quotations that support it	Is the evidence relevant and sufficient?
Assumptions (warrants)	The general principles that link evidence to claim	Would the audience share this assumption?
Counterarguments	Objections and alternative views, acknowledged and answered	What would a sceptical reader say?

KEY IDEA · Booth et al.'s core of argument

A **claim**, backed by **reasons**, based on **evidence**, with an **acknowledgment and response** to other views, and — when readers might not see the link — a **warrant** explaining why the reason supports the claim.

Toulmin element	Function	Literary example
Claim	What you want the reader to accept	Louise Mallard's "joy" is real freedom, not grief.
Grounds	The evidence	She whispers "free, free, free!" and her eyes grow bright.
Warrant	Why the evidence supports the claim	Repeated private speech reveals a character's true feeling.
Backing	Support for the warrant	Narrative theory on interior monologue and free indirect discourse.
Qualifier	How strongly the claim holds	at least in the hour the story describes
Rebuttal	Conditions or objections	Unless the narrator's irony is read as mocking her.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 1.1 Analyse a sample argument ⏱ 20 min

Identify the elements of argument in this short opinion piece (constructed for practice).

EXAMPLE · Sample argument

Universities should require every student, whatever their field, to take one literature course. Employers increasingly say they need graduates who can interpret ambiguity and understand other perspectives, and reading fiction trains precisely these abilities: a novel asks us to inhabit minds unlike our own. Some will object that timetables are already overloaded and that literature has no practical value. Yet a single course costs little, and the skills it builds — careful reading, interpretation, persuasive writing — are among the most transferable a university can offer.

Element	In the text
Issue	
Claim	
Reasons and evidence	
Assumption (warrant)	
Counterargument and response	
Main appeal(s)	

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA1 · Argument analysis · due Week 2

Choose an opinion article (600–1,000 words) from a reputable newspaper or magazine. In **300 words**, identify its issue, claim, reasons, evidence, assumptions and counterarguments, and evaluate how effectively it uses the three appeals.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 2

Writing Effective Arguments

Strategies for an effective style of argument; structuring an argument beyond the five-paragraph essay; analysing a sample response.

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 6–7; Booth et al.

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

2.1 Strategies for an effective style

- **Know your audience**: write for an intelligent reader who has read the text but not thought about your issue.
- **State the issue** before the claim, so readers see why a claim is needed.
- **Make a specific, arguable claim** — not a fact, not a plot summary, not a personal preference.
- **Prefer analysis to summary**: assume the reader knows the plot; explain how and why details mean.
- **Adopt a credible tone**: confident but fair, hedged where the evidence is limited.
- **Answer the "So what? Who cares?" question** (Graff & Birkenstein): show what your claim changes in our understanding.

2.2 Beyond the five-paragraph essay

Five-paragraph essay	Developed academic argument
Introduction ending with a three-point thesis	Introduction that poses an issue, shows what others think, and states a claim
Three parallel body paragraphs	Sections that build on each other: each reason prepares the next
No opposing view	A naysayer section: objection fairly stated, then answered or conceded
Conclusion repeating the thesis	Conclusion that extends: implications, wider significance, open questions

WRITER'S TIP · Planting a naysayer (Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 6)

- Some readers may object that… · It might be argued that…
- Although this objection has merit, it overlooks…
- Granted, …; nevertheless, …

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 2.1 Break the formula ⏱ 15 min

Rewrite this five-paragraph thesis as an issue + claim that a developed argument could defend: "In 'The Story of an Hour' Kate Chopin uses irony, symbolism and setting to show the theme of freedom."

Task 2.2 Write a naysayer paragraph ⏱ 15 min

Write 80–100 words that state and answer one objection to the sample argument of Week 1 or to your own claim.

Task 2.3 Analyse a sample response ⏱ 10 min

Your tutor will give you a student response to an argument. Note one strength and one weakness for each: claim · evidence · counterargument · conclusion.

FURTHER READING

- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 6, "Skeptics May Object", and Ch. 7, "So What? Who Cares?".
- Schilb & Clifford (2014), Part One, chapters on the elements of argument.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 3

How to Argue about Literature

Arguable issues in literary texts; strategies for arguing about literature; a sample student argument on the two stories.

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford, Part One; Murray

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

3.1 The two stories

	Daniel Orozco, "Orientation"	Jamaica Kincaid, "Girl"
Form	A monologue in the second person: a speaker orients a new employee around an office	A single long sentence of instructions from a mother to her daughter, with the daughter's brief interjections
Setting	A contemporary corporate workplace	Antigua, in a Caribbean domestic and colonial context
Questions to explore	Routine and secrecy; humour and menace; what the institution demands of individuals	Gendered expectations; love and control; voice and silence; colonial respectability

3.2 Types of issues in literary argument

Schilb and Clifford list recurring kinds of issues that critics argue about. Turning a topic into one of these questions is the first step towards a claim.

Type of issue	Sample question
Fact	Does the new employee in “Orientation” ever speak?
Theme	What does “Girl” suggest about how identity is shaped by instruction?
Definition	Is “Girl” a short story, a prose poem or a dramatic monologue?
Symbolism	What does the office layout come to stand for in “Orientation”?
Pattern	How do repeated warnings function in “Girl”?
Contextualisation	How does colonial Antigua shape the mother’s values?
Evaluation	Is the humour of “Orientation” a strength or a distraction?
Social policy	What does either story imply about how institutions should treat people?

KEY IDEA · Strategies for arguing about literature

- Write in the **literary present**: *the mother warns*, not *warned*.
- Distinguish the **author**, the **speaker** and the **characters**.
- Ground every claim in **specific textual evidence**, and explain it: quotation is not proof until you analyse it.
- Do not merely summarise the plot; argue for an **interpretation** a thoughtful reader could dispute.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 3.1 From topic to arguable claim ⏱ 15 min

For each story, write one issue (question) and one arguable claim answering it.

	Issue	Claim
“Orientation”		
“Girl”		

Task 3.2 Evaluate a sample student argument ⏱ 10 min

Read the student paragraph your tutor distributes. Is the claim arguable? Is the evidence analysed or only quoted? Suggest one revision.

FURTHER READING

- Schilb & Clifford (2014), Part One, chapter on strategies for arguing about literature (types of issues).
- Murray (2012), chapter on essay structure and argument.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 4

The Reading Process: Close Reading

Strategies for close reading; reading "Orientation" and "Girl" closely by annotating.

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford, Part One; Wright (2024); Murray

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

4.1 Three readings

1. **First reading — orientation**: who speaks, to whom, where, about what? Note your first reactions and questions.
2. **Second reading — annotation**: mark patterns, contrasts, shifts and puzzling details with the code below.
3. **Third reading — interpretation**: choose a pattern and ask what it means and why it matters. This becomes your issue.

4.2 What to look for

Feature	Questions	Code
Repetition and pattern	Which words, structures or images recur? Do they change?	R
Contrast and binary	What oppositions organise the text (inside/outside, respectable/shameful)?	⇄
Shift	Where does tone, addressee or subject suddenly change?	↯
Voice	Who speaks? Who is silent? How reliable is the speaker?	V
Diction and syntax	Which word choices are surprising? How do sentence length and structure create effects?	D
Imagery	Which concrete images carry meaning beyond the literal?	I
Question / anomaly	What seems strange, ambiguous or unexplained?	?

WRITER'S TIP · Grammar as evidence

Wright (2024) shows that grammatical choices are interpretive evidence. In "Girl", notice the imperative mood and the one-sentence structure; in "Orientation", notice the second-person *you* and the shifts between procedure and confession. Ask what each choice does to the reader.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 4.1 Annotate ⏱ 30 min

Annotate both stories with the code above. Then complete the close-reading grid.

	"Orientation"	"Girl"
Strongest pattern		
Key contrast		
Most important shift		
A detail I cannot explain yet		

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA2 · Annotated reading · due Week 5

Submit a photocopy of one story with your annotations and a **250-word** commentary explaining the pattern you find most significant and the interpretive question it raises.

FURTHER READING

- Schilb & Clifford (2014), Part One, chapter on the reading process.
- Wright (2024), chapters on grammar as evidence in literary analysis.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 5

Writing a Comparative Paper: Exploring and Planning

Strategies for exploring and planning a comparison of "Orientation" and "Girl".

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford (the writing process); Graff & Birkenstein; Booth et al.

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

5.1 Why compare?

A good comparison is not a list of similarities and differences. The two texts illuminate each other: reading one **through** the other reveals something you would not see in either alone. Your claim states that insight.

5.2 Exploring

- **Freewrite** for ten minutes on each story, then on both together.
- **List** shared elements: a speaker who instructs; a silent or nearly silent listener; rules about behaviour; hidden threat or judgement.
- **Ask questions** that bridge the texts: *How does each speaker use instruction to exercise power? What does each listener's silence mean?*
- **Look for the difference within the similarity**: the strongest comparisons find texts alike in one way and revealingly different in another.

5.3 Planning: two organisations

Block (text by text)	Point by point (issue by issue)
I. Introduction and claim II. "Orientation": points 1, 2, 3 III. "Girl": points 1, 2, 3, related back to "Orientation" IV. Conclusion	I. Introduction and claim II. Point 1 in both stories III. Point 2 in both stories IV. Point 3 in both stories V. Conclusion
Simpler, but risks two separate essays	Better for a sustained comparison; requires strong transitions

KEY IDEA · A working comparative thesis

Although both X and Y…, X…, whereas Y…; this difference reveals… — e.g., "Although both stories present a speaker who instructs a silent listener, Orozco's institution conceals its violence behind routine while Kincaid's mother makes judgement explicit; together they show how instruction produces conformity." (Model only; make your own.)

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 5.1 Comparison grid ⏱ 20 min

Complete the grid in pairs, with page references.

Basis of comparison	"Orientation"	"Girl"	Similar or different? So what?
Speaker and listener			
Rules and instructions			
Power and authority			
Tone (humour, menace, tenderness)			

Task 5.2 Draft a working thesis ⏱ 10 min

Write a working comparative thesis using the model above.

FURTHER READING

- Schilb & Clifford (2014), Part One, chapter on the writing process (exploring and planning).

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 6

Planning and Composing the Comparative Paper

Strategies for writing a comparative paper; strategies for composing; the first draft.

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 8; Williams & Bizup

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

6.1 The comparative introduction

1. Open with the **issue** both texts raise (not a dictionary definition, not "Since the dawn of time").
2. Introduce the texts: author, title, date, a one-line description.
3. State your **comparative claim** and, briefly, how the paper will develop it.

6.2 The comparative body paragraph

Step	Function
Topic sentence	States the point of comparison as a claim
Evidence from text A	Short quotation or precise reference, analysed
Transition	Similarly / By contrast / Whereas / Unlike
Evidence from text B	Short quotation or precise reference, analysed
So what?	What the comparison reveals, linked back to the thesis

WRITER'S TIP · **Strategies for composing**

- Write the body first if the introduction blocks you.
- Keep a "parking lot" document for good ideas that do not fit.
- Use connecting words and pointing phrases (Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 8) to link paragraphs: *This pattern of concealment…*
- Keep characters as subjects and actions as verbs (Williams & Bizup): *The mother warns*, not *There is a warning by the mother*.

EXAMPLE · **Model comparative paragraph (public-domain texts)**

[**Topic sentence**] Both Chopin's "The Story of an Hour" (1894) and Gilman's "The Yellow Wallpaper" (1892) locate a woman's confinement in the language of loving care. [**Text A**] Chopin's Louise expects to weep at "the kind, tender hands folded in death," yet the tenderness she remembers is precisely what she is relieved to escape. [**Transition + Text B**] Gilman's narrator, by contrast, cannot even name her husband's control as control: "John laughs at me, of course, but one expects that in marriage." [**So what?**] Where Chopin grants her heroine an hour of clear self-knowledge, Gilman denies hers the vocabulary for it — a difference that explains why one story ends in a single shock and the other in a slow descent.

MLA in-text page numbers depend on your edition, e.g. (Chopin 2); (Gilman 647).

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 6.1 Outline ⏱ 20 min

Outline your paper using the point-by-point model: thesis, three topic sentences, one piece of evidence from each story per point.

Task 6.2 Introduction 15 min

Draft your introduction (100–130 words) in class; complete the first draft (1,000–1,200 words) at home for Week 7.

FURTHER READING

- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 8, "As a Result: Connecting the Parts".
- Williams & Bizup (2015), lessons on cohesion and coherence.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 7

Revising · Selecting and Incorporating Quotations (MLA)

Strategies for revising; a checklist; integrating quotations in MLA style; the final draft of the comparative paper.

Key sources: Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 3; MLA Handbook (9th ed.); Booth et al.

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

7.1 Revision checklist for the comparative paper

Area	Check
Claim	☐ Comparative, arguable, specific? ☐ Does it say what the comparison reveals?
Structure	☐ Each paragraph treats both texts? ☐ Points build towards the conclusion?
Evidence	☐ Quotations short, precise, analysed? ☐ No plot summary for its own sake?
Style	☐ Literary present? ☐ Clear transitions of comparison? ☐ Concise sentences?
MLA	☐ In-text citations correct? ☐ Works Cited complete?

7.2 The quotation sandwich

Graff and Birkenstein insist that quotations do not speak for themselves. **Introduce** the quotation (who speaks, in what context), **quote** only the words that matter, and **explain** what they mean and why they matter for your claim. Example with a public-domain text:

EXAMPLE · **Kate Chopin, "The Story of an Hour" (1894)**

When Louise Mallard imagines the years ahead, she realises that "there would be no one to live for her during those coming years; she would live for herself" (Chopin 2). The parallel clauses turn a widow's grief into a declaration of independence: the repetition of "live for" moves the self from object to subject.

MLA rule	Example
Author + page, no comma	(Chopin 2) · Chopin describes… (2).

MLA rule	Example
Omit words with an ellipsis	"there would be no one to live for her … she would live for herself" (Chopin 2)
Add or change words in brackets	"[S]he would live for herself" (Chopin 2)
Block quotation	More than four lines of prose: indent 0.5 inch, no quotation marks, citation after the final period
Punctuation	Period after the parenthesis: …herself" (Chopin 2).

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 7.1 Repair the quotations ⏱ 15 min

Rewrite this "hit-and-run" quotation as a sandwich, choosing a short quotation from one of the two stories: *Kincaid's mother gives many orders. "[long quotation]". This shows she is strict.*

Task 7.2 Revise with a partner ⏱ 20 min

Exchange drafts. Using the checklist, mark the two most serious problems and suggest a solution for each.

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA3 · Comparative paper, final draft · due Week 8

Submit the revised comparative paper (**1,000–1,200 words**, MLA format, Works Cited) with your first draft and a short note on the three main changes you made.

FURTHER READING

- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 3, "As He Himself Puts It: The Art of Quoting".
- MLA Handbook (2021), chapter on quotations.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 8

Writing Researched Arguments

Analysing a sample MLA paper; giving research a direction; searching databases; evaluating sources.

Key sources: Schilb & Clifford (researched arguments); Booth et al., Ch. 3–6; MLA Handbook

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

8.1 What a sample MLA research paper shows

- A heading (name, instructor, course, date), a centred title, surname and page number in the header.
- An introduction that reports the critical conversation before stating the writer's claim.
- Critics used to **support, extend or challenge** the reading — never to replace it.
- A Works Cited list with every source cited, and nothing that is not cited.

8.2 Giving research a direction

Booth et al. move from a **topic** to a **question** to a **problem**: *I am working on [topic] because I want to find out [question] in order to help my reader understand [significance].* Start from the question your comparative paper raised but could not answer without critics or context.

8.3 Searching databases

Database	Best for
MLA International Bibliography	The standard index of scholarship on literature, language and linguistics

Database	Best for
JSTOR	Full texts of journal back issues and many books in the humanities
Project MUSE	Recent humanities journals and books
Google Scholar	Broad discovery; check the publisher and peer-review status of every hit

WRITER'S TIP · Search strategies

- **AND** narrows (Kincaid AND colonialism); **OR** widens (mother OR maternal); **NOT** excludes.
- Use "quotation marks" for phrases ("mother-daughter") and * for truncation (colonial* → colonial, colonialism).
- Filter by peer review, date and language; follow the bibliographies of the best articles.
- Evaluate every source with the Semester 1 criteria (Week 4).

EXAMPLE · Layout of an MLA first page

- Top left, double-spaced: Your Name · Instructor's Name · Course · 12 March 2027 (day month year).
- Header, top right: Surname and page number (e.g., Ben Ali 1).
- Title centred, in title case, not bold or underlined; no title page.
- Text double-spaced, first line of each paragraph indented 0.5 inch, 12-point readable font.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 8.1 Build search strings ⏱ 15 min

Write two search strings for your research question and record the number of results in the MLA International Bibliography or JSTOR.

Task 8.2 Evaluate three hits ⏱ 15 min

Choose three results and judge each in one sentence: author, venue, date, relevance.

FURTHER READING

- Booth et al. (2024), chapters on finding and evaluating sources.
- Schilb & Clifford (2014), Part One, chapter on writing researched arguments.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 9

Writing an Annotated Bibliography in MLA Format

Recording sources' key details; summarising and paraphrasing critical sources.

Key sources: MLA Handbook (9th ed.); Swales & Feak, Unit 5; Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 2

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

9.1 MLA core elements

MLA builds every entry from the same **core elements**, in this order, with the punctuation shown: **Author. Title of source. Title of container, Other contributors, Version, Number, Publisher, Publication date, Location.** A source can sit in a second container (an article in a journal in a database).

Type	MLA Works Cited pattern
Book	Murray, Neil. *Writing Essays in English Language and Linguistics.* Cambridge UP, 2012.
Story in an anthology	Kincaid, Jamaica. "Girl." *Arguing about Literature: A Guide and Reader,* edited by John Schilb and John Clifford, Bedford/St. Martin's, 2014, pp. [range].
Journal article in a database	Surname, First Name. "Title of Article." *Journal Title,* vol. 12, no. 3, 2020, pp. 45–67. *JSTOR,* doi or stable URL.

KEY IDEA · MLA versus APA (Semester 1)

MLA puts the **full first name** first, the **date near the end**, titles in **title case**, and cites **page numbers** without "p." — (Kincaid 3). APA puts **initials**, the **date after the author**, and cites author–year — (Kincaid, 1978, p. 3).

9.2 Recording key details

Keep a research log so you never lose a reference: full MLA entry · where you found it · the critic's main claim · two key quotations with pages · your paraphrase · how the source relates to your claim (supports / extends / challenges).

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 9.1 Build MLA entries 15 min

Convert into MLA: (a) Graff & Birkenstein's *They Say / I Say*, 5th ed., Norton, 2021; (b) Hyland, K. (2005). Stance and engagement. *Discourse Studies, 7*(2), 173–192.

Task 9.2 Summarise a critic 15 min

Write a 60-word summary and a one-sentence paraphrase of one critical source you found in Week 8, with MLA citation.

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA4 · MLA annotated bibliography · due Week 10

Compile an annotated bibliography of **five sources** (at least three peer-reviewed) for your researched argument, each with a 100–150-word annotation (summary + evaluation + relevance), in MLA format. In Week 10, present your research question and plan orally (**5 minutes**).

FURTHER READING

- MLA Handbook (2021), chapters on the core elements and the list of works cited.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 10

Planning the Research Paper: Reviewing Scholarly Debates

Reconstructing the critical conversation; analysing sample reviews from literary journals.

Key sources: Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 1, 4; Swales & Feak, Unit 6; Booth et al.

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

10.1 Mapping the debate

Before stating your own claim, show the reader the conversation you are joining. Group critics by **position**, not by date of reading. Graff and Birkenstein offer templates for the "they say": *Critics have often read X as…; More recently, Y has challenged this view by…* Then place yourself: **agree and extend**, **disagree with reasons**, or **agree in part**.

Position on "Girl" (hypothetical, for practice)	Where I stand
A: The mother is primarily oppressive; the story is about silencing.	
B: The mother is protective; her rules respond to colonial and economic pressures.	
C: The form — one breathless sentence — matters more than the content.	

10.2 Reading reviews in literary journals

Move in a scholarly review	Function
Context	Places the book in its field and debate
Summary	Outlines the argument and structure fairly
Evaluation	Assesses contribution, evidence, method — praise and criticism, hedged and specific
Recommendation	Says who should read it and why

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 10.1 Analyse a review ⏱ 15 min

In a review provided by your tutor, label the four moves and underline the evaluative language (cf. stance markers, Semester 1, Week 9).

Task 10.2 They say / I say paragraph ⏱ 20 min

Write 120 words that summarise two positions in the debate on your topic and state where you stand.

FURTHER READING

- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 1, "They Say: Starting with What Others Are Saying".
- Swales & Feak (2012), Unit 6, on evaluative language.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 11

Organizing the Research Paper

Structuring the research paper; building an argument with textual and critical evidence; drafting.

Key sources: Booth et al., Ch. 7–12; Schilb & Clifford; Graff & Birkenstein

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

Part	Content	Length (2,000 words)
Introduction	Issue · critical conversation ("they say") · your claim ("I say") · roadmap	250–300
Section 1	First reason: close reading of key passages, supported or contrasted with critics	450–500
Section 2	Second reason, building on the first; comparison or context as needed	450–500
Counterargument	The strongest alternative reading, fairly stated and answered	250–300
Conclusion	So what? Implications for reading the story and for the debate	200–250
Works Cited	MLA list of all sources cited	—

KEY IDEA · Primary and secondary evidence

The **story** is your primary evidence: every section needs close reading. **Critics** are secondary evidence: use them to frame, support or challenge your reading. A paper that only reports critics has no argument; a paper that ignores them is not research.

EXAMPLE · Model introduction for a researched argument (Chopin, public domain)

[**Issue**] Why does Louise Mallard die at the end of "The Story of an Hour"? [**They say**] Many critics read her death as punishment for a fantasy of independence, the story's final verdict on her "monstrous joy". Others treat the ending as a twist that merely shocks. [**I say**] I argue instead that the ending turns the reader's attention from Louise to those who interpret her: the doctors' diagnosis is the story's last and least reliable reading. [**Roadmap**] After examining the free indirect discourse of the central scene, I consider the ending's irony and answer the objection that Chopin's narrator shares the doctors' view.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 11.1 Sentence outline ⏱ 20 min

Write your claim and one topic sentence (a claim, not a topic) for each section. Note the primary and secondary evidence each will use.

Task 11.2 Reverse outline ⏱ 15 min

After drafting at home, write one line summarising each paragraph. Mark paragraphs that do not advance the claim and decide whether to cut, move or rewrite them.

FURTHER READING

- Booth et al. (2024), chapters on planning and drafting a report and on revising your organisation.

SEMESTER 2 · WEEK 12

MLA Style: Citing, Incorporating and Documenting Sources

In-text citations, signal phrases and the list of works cited.

Key sources: MLA Handbook (9th ed.); Graff & Birkenstein, Ch. 3

NOTES · KEY CONCEPTS AND MODELS

Situation	MLA in-text citation
Author named in a signal phrase	As Kincaid's narrator insists, … (3).
Author not named	… (Kincaid 3).
Two authors / three or more	(Schilb and Clifford 45) · (Booth et al. 112)
Two works by the same author	(Kincaid, "Girl" 3) — add a short title
Indirect source	(qtd. in Surname 27)
No page numbers (website)	Author only, or paragraph number if given: (Surname, par. 4)

12.1 Formatting the Works Cited list

- New page titled **Works Cited**, centred, not bold.
- Alphabetical by author's surname; hanging indent of 0.5 inch; double-spaced throughout.
- Titles in title case: *italics* for books, journals and anthologies; "quotation marks" for stories, poems and articles.
- Use a word processor's paragraph settings for indents, never spaces or tabs.

WATCH OUT · Common MLA errors

- A comma between author and page: write (Kincaid 3), not (Kincaid, 3).
- Using "p." before the page number.
- APA-style dates after the author's name.
- Sources in the Works Cited that are never cited in the paper.

PRACTICE · WORKSHOP TASKS

Task 12.1 Correct the citations 10 min

Correct: (a) (Orozco, p. 12) (b) Kincaid says in her story Girl that… (Kincaid, 1978) (c) Booth, Colomb, Williams, Bizup and FitzGerald argue (2024, p. 112).

HOME ASSIGNMENT · HA5 · Researched argument, final draft · due Week 13

Submit your researched literary argument (**1,500–2,000 words**, at least four scholarly sources, MLA format and Works Cited) with your annotated bibliography and reverse outline.

FURTHER READING

- MLA Handbook (2021), chapters on in-text citation and the works-cited list.
- Graff & Birkenstein (2021), Ch. 3, on framing quotations.

Weeks 13–14 · Mid-term test and wrap-up

Week 13: classroom mid-term test — argument analysis, close reading of a short passage, a comparative or argumentative paragraph with integrated quotations, and MLA citation. **Week 14:** correction of the test and reflection: *How has my reading of literature changed, and what will I take into my mémoire?*

PART E

Appendices

Appendix A · Correction code

Tutors mark errors with these codes. Record your most frequent ones in Appendix C and check for them before every submission.

Code	Meaning	Code	Meaning
Sp	Spelling	Ref	Reference missing or incorrect (APA / MLA)
Gr	Grammar (agreement, articles, word form)	Pl	Plagiarism or patchwriting
T	Verb tense (e.g., literary present)	Q	Quotation not introduced or not explained
WW	Wrong word / collocation	Sum	Plot or source summary instead of analysis
Reg	Register too informal	Cl	Claim unclear, not arguable or missing
P	Punctuation	Ev	Evidence missing, weak or not analysed
SS	Sentence structure (fragment, run-on)	Coh	Cohesion: missing link or transition
∧	Something missing	H	Over-claim: hedge needed
¶	New paragraph needed	Wdy	Wordy: cut or simplify

Appendix B · Assessment rubric for home assignments (20 marks)

The criteria are those named in the official programme (section 6.2).

Criterion	Excellent (4)	Good (3)	Developing (2)	Weak (0–1)
Argumentation	Clear, arguable, significant claim; reasons build logically; objections answered	Clear claim; mostly logical support	Claim vague; support uneven	No identifiable claim
Structure and clarity	Purposeful organisation; strong topic sentences and transitions	Logical; minor lapses in flow	Some paragraphs lack focus	Disorganised
Use of sources and evidence	Sources synthesised and analysed; evidence precise and explained	Sources used appropriately; some explanation	Sources summarised rather than used	Few or no sources; possible plagiarism
Language accuracy and register	Accurate, concise, academic; stance well controlled	Few errors; mostly academic	Frequent errors that sometimes obscure meaning	Errors impede understanding
Disciplinary conventions	APA / MLA, genre and format followed throughout	Minor citation or format errors	Inconsistent conventions	Conventions ignored

Appendix C · Assignment and error tracker

Assignment	Submitted	Mark /20	Main feedback to act on
S1 · HA1 Analytical summary			
S1 · HA2 APA annotated bibliography			
S1 · HA3 Synthesis paper + oral			
S1 · HA4 Data commentary			
S1 · HA5 Abstract			
S2 · HA1 Argument analysis			
S2 · HA2 Annotated reading			
S2 · HA3 Comparative paper			
S2 · HA4 MLA annotated bibliography + oral			

Assignment	Submitted	Mark /20	Main feedback to act on
S2 · HA5 Researched argument			

My most frequent errors (update after each marked assignment):

_____

Appendix D · Final checklist before submitting

Before I submit, I have checked that…	✓
my claim (thesis) is stated clearly in the introduction and answers the question or issue	
each paragraph has a topic sentence and supports the claim	
every idea, quotation or paraphrase from a source is cited in the correct style (APA in S1, MLA in S2)	
quotations are introduced, short and explained (quotation sandwich)	
claims are hedged where the evidence is limited, and my voice is distinct from my sources'	
the reference list / Works Cited is complete, alphabetical and has hanging indents	
the document is word-processed with page numbers, consistent font and line spacing	
I have read the text aloud and corrected the errors in my tracker (Appendix C)	
the work is entirely my own, in line with the department's rules on plagiarism and generative AI	

Appendix E · APA and MLA at a glance

	APA 7 (Semester 1)	MLA 9 (Semester 2)
In-text, paraphrase	(Murray, 2012)	(Murray 45)
In-text, quotation	(Murray, 2012, p. 45)	(Murray 45)
Three or more authors	(Booth et al., 2024)	(Booth et al. 112)
Book entry	Murray, N. (2012). *Writing essays in English language and linguistics.* Cambridge University Press.	Murray, Neil. *Writing Essays in English Language and Linguistics.* Cambridge UP, 2012.
Journal article	Hyland, K. (2005). Stance and engagement: A model of interaction in academic discourse. *Discourse Studies, 7*(2), 173–192.	Hyland, Ken. "Stance and Engagement: A Model of Interaction in Academic Discourse." *Discourse Studies,* vol. 7, no. 2, 2005, pp. 173–92.
List title	References	Works Cited
Title capitalisation	Sentence case for books and articles	Title case for all titles